

Digital toys

Today even the very young interact with technology, often in the form of games and apps on their parents' smartphones or tablets. Technology can help children learn through play.

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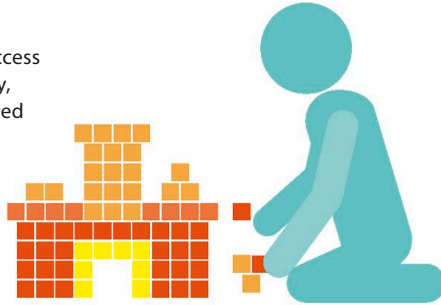
92–93 ▶

Technology for the very young

For kids aged between two and five, technology is not all about computers. Anything where pressing a button makes something happen can be considered some kind of technology. Almost without exception, children find technology interesting, exciting, and motivating. Of course, too much reliance on technology can be detrimental, particularly when not supported by interaction with a parent or caregiver. However, children can gain useful skills exploring technology as part of a wide range of play activities.

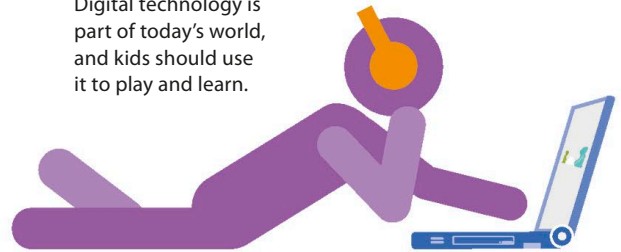
▷ Non-digital toys

Though kids have access to digital technology, they are still interested in non-digital toys and games.



▽ Digital toys

Digital technology is part of today's world, and kids should use it to play and learn.

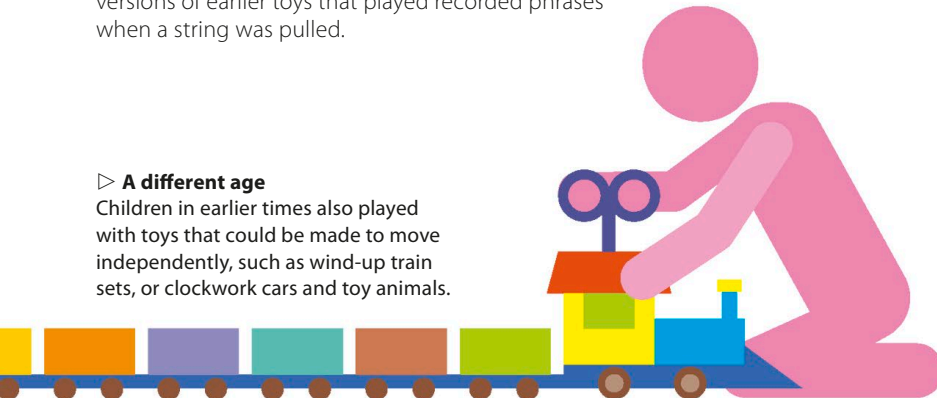


Toys containing computers

Many toys today include small, embedded computers that make the toy move or emit sounds. They may include speech recognition programs that enable them to react to a child's instructions, or sensors that react when the toy is touched. These are essentially updated versions of earlier toys that played recorded phrases when a string was pulled.

▷ A different age

Children in earlier times also played with toys that could be made to move independently, such as wind-up train sets, or clockwork cars and toy animals.



REAL WORLD

Automatons

Children's toys that try to give the appearance of being alive through technology have been popular since the 19th century. These toys, known as automatons, were usually powered by clockwork or by a user moving them directly by turning a handle.

